

# The Evidence Trap

Why fact-based conflicts never settle · Wikipedia ArbCom · 53 cases · 2004–2025

## FACT DISPUTES

Geopolitics + Science · orange persists throughout

Religion avg

all cases

Policy avg

all cases

Science avg

all cases

Politics avg

all cases

Geopolitics avg

all cases

Social avg

all cases

Group averages — all cases:  
evidence record  
still growing at  $\frac{2}{3}$

Armenia–Azer. 2023

Arb. Sanctions 2011

Palestine–Israel 2019

Arb. Enforcement 2015

Skepticism 2022

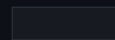
American Politics 2015

Climate Change 2010

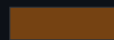
American Politics 2014

start  $\frac{1}{3}$   $\frac{2}{3}$  end

Evidence fraction:



none



low



mid



high



peak

/// = after last edit (case closed). Thin rows = individual cases. Thick rows = all-case group average.

## CONDUCT DISPUTES

Politics + Policy · orange clears in first  $\frac{1}{3}$

one burst of  
evidence, then done

dark after  $\frac{1}{3}$ ;  
committee decides

start  $\frac{1}{3}$   $\frac{2}{3}$  end